



MONTHLY UPDATE

Central Africa: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 9 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION ·
SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION

Summary of the month

Payments infrastructure carried the month: BEAC put [SYSTAC 2 into production on 3 August](#), replacing a platform in service since 2007, and its [PAPSS accession](#) reached its first public test when Cameroonian businesses [reported no operational access a month on](#). Africa CDC [closed a health-data-sharing workshop in Libreville on 21 August](#) setting short deadlines for a data-sharing convention, and a [CEMAC/ILO labour-statistics workshop in Pointe-Noire](#) produced a regional methodological guide against the organisers' own finding that no member state runs a regular labour force survey. Two announcements — a [Central Africa Peering Forum](#) and a [PIDA data-centre prospectus](#) — were published with no delivery yet behind them.

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

Africa CDC [closed a regional advocacy workshop in Libreville on 21 August](#) setting a six-week deadline for drafting an inter-country health-data-sharing convention and a four-week deadline for a formal sharing mechanism, to be put to the health ministers of the seven of nine member states that have yet to sign the underlying protocol. The deadlines fall after this window and are not yet due.

The regional data-governance framework closed its consultations. [The Douala sessions ended on 4 September with 27 participants and European Union and German development backing](#), a framework and an accompanying roadmap [due out of them](#). No draft text, adoption route, member-state commitment or publication date for either is held — which leaves the region with a process and no instrument.

Instruments and harmonisation

Standards

A trade-press account of the CEMAC interoperable QR-code standard [put GIMAC's tariff structure under revision on 3 August](#), GIMAC's director-general conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments — the tariff-revision workshop itself opened 30 July, just outside this window, and the revised grid still needs BEAC's agreement, with entry into force hoped for 1 January 2027.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

A [Central Africa Peering Forum](#) was announced for Yaounde, 30 September to 1 October, covering peering, interconnection, routing security and RPKI. It closes a 2026 regional calendar that already ran West Africa's forum in Cotonou in June and the continental AfPIF in Kigali in August, and the announcement itself carries no agenda or attendance detail yet.

Data Storage

The African Union's PIDA programme [published a project prospectus for ECCAS-level data-centre infrastructure on 25 August](#), framed as underpinning the digital economy. No financing, sponsor or timetable is stated in the prospectus itself.

Digital Payments and Fintech

BEAC [put SYSTAC 2 into production on 3 August](#), the bank's own communique settling a date a trade-press account had misdated to 2027: a centralised, fully online ISO 20022-compliant platform for transfers, direct debits, cheques and card payments across all six CEMAC states, with the instant-payments module explicitly not yet in production and the incoming RTGS system SYGMA V10 dated only to "the coming weeks". [Further reporting through the month](#) added no new capability beyond BEAC's own account.

BEAC's July accession to PAPSS had its first public test this month: a Cameroonian trade outlet [reported on 25 August that Cameroonian businesses still had no operational access](#) to the continental settlement rail, with no public list yet of operational Cameroonian banks, open corridors, tariffs or ceilings.

National statistics

A nine-day CEMAC/ILO workshop [closed in Pointe-Noire on 27 August](#), producing a regional methodological guide and a preliminary roadmap toward quarterly labour-force surveys across the six member states — against the organisers' own statement that no member state currently runs one. The [World Bank-financed HISWACA workshop put informal employment above 65% of jobs bloc-wide and unemployment ranging from 1.1% in Chad to nearly 20% in Gabon](#).

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

The region's own training institution came back into view on 4 August, when the ECCAS commissioner for gender and human development [visited the African Institute of Informatics in Yaounde and opened collaboration on education and digital skills](#). The institute is inter-state by construction — it is the one training body in this ledger the region owns rather than hosts. Nothing in the account carries an enrolment figure, a qualification, or a commitment beyond the visit.

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